GET INVOLVED

How to Participate

Phase 0 is the right moment to ask questions, raise concerns, and help shape what comes next.

Village Residents & Landowners

Your land, local knowledge and voice shape the design. Join the community consultation.

Forestry & Energy Professionals

Feasibility input, technical review, and partnership in implementation.

Investors & Philanthropists

Phase 0 funding for feasibility studies, legal structure, and early outreach.

Researchers & Academics

Collaborate on open data, carbon measurement, and rural energy modelling.

Other Rural Communities

Everything built here is documented and shared openly — free for any village to replicate.

Mitsue.

ECOLOGY · ENERGY · DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

mitsue.it

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Mitsue Village, Nara Prefecture, Japan
Version 2.0 · May 2026

PHASE 0 · 2026

THE MITSUE PROJECT

Ecology · Energy
Digital Infrastructure for Rural Japan

MITSUE VILLAGE · NARA · JAPAN

THE PROJECT

Three Pillars

Forest Restoration

Aging cedar monoculture replaced with native mixed forest, healing land depleted for decades. Landowners receive timber income from Year 2.

EV Charging & Energy Resilience

Solar panels and battery storage at the school supply clean local energy, EV charging for the community, and backup power during blackouts.

Sustainable AI Data Center

A small, efficient digital facility inside the old school, powered entirely by local renewable energy — creating employment and stable revenue where none existed.

> *"These are not three separate ideas — each one makes the others possible."*

PHASE 0 · NOW OPEN

What We're Building

The closed Mitsue Elementary School and its surrounding cedar forest — transformed into a living model of rural self-sufficiency.

WHY HERE?

- ✓ Closed school available for reuse
- ✓ Productive cedar forest within reach
- ✓ River for natural water cooling
- ✓ Resident engineer with deep local roots
- ✓ Village leadership open to new ideas

FUNDED BY

林野庁 forest grants · METI/NEDO energy & EV grants · FIT/FIP feed-in tariff · J-Credit carbon income · Data center service revenue · Impact investment & philanthropy

ADVISORS

Joi Ito — Former Director, MIT Media Lab

Ray Ozzie — Former Chief Software Architect, Microsoft

MILESTONES

Timeline

Benefits arrive well before Year 25 — the 25-year horizon describes full forest restoration, not how long the village waits.

Year 1	School reactivated; international media visibility for Mitsue
Year 2	Landowners begin receiving income from cedar harvest
Year 3–4	EV charging operational; battery storage for village blackout resilience
Year 4–5	Data center operational; local jobs in operations & maintenance
Year 5–10	Revenue reinvested into village and forest programmes
Year 25	Native forest established; model documented and shared openly

About the Team

Rob Oudendijk — Dutch electrical engineer, resident of Mitsue since 2012. Core hardware developer for *Safecast*, the open citizen science network born after Fukushima, with over 250 million published measurements.

A dedicated non-profit is being established with local residents, village leadership, forestry professionals, and academic partners.